

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 19 OF 70

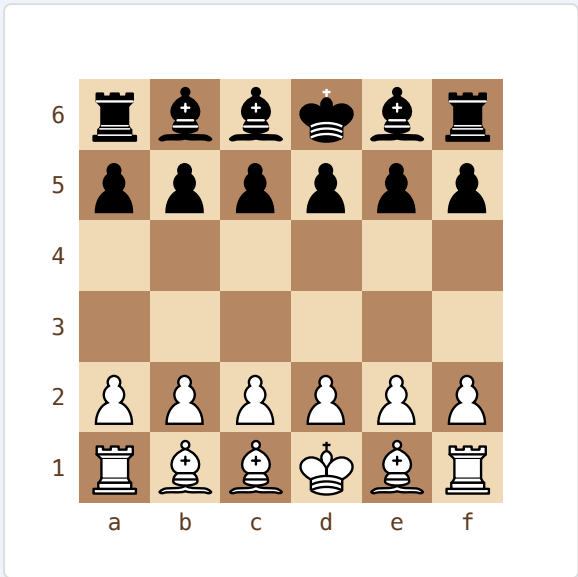
# Diana Chess

**6×6**  
BOARD

**2**  
PLAYERS

# DIANA CHESS

A 6×6 variant with no Queens and no Knights. Only Rooks, Bishops, King, and Pawns. Clean, positional play on a compact board.



Diana Chess — starting position (6×6)

## SETUP

**Board:** 6×6 (six files, six ranks).

**Setup (FEN):** rbbkr1/pppppp/6/6/PPPPPP/RBBKR1

Black (rank 6): Rook, Bishop, Bishop, King, Rook, empty. White (rank 1): Rook, Bishop, Bishop, King, Rook, empty.

Each side has: 1 King, 2 Rooks, 2 Bishops, 5 Pawns (files a–e occupied; f-file back rank empty).

## RULES

- ♦ Rooks, Bishops, King, and Pawns move as in standard chess.
- ♦ No Queens and no Knights exist in this variant.
- ♦ Pawns move one square forward only (no double-step).
- ♦ No en passant.
- ♦ No castling.
- ♦ Pawns promote on the far rank to Rook or Bishop only.

## WIN CONDITION

Checkmate.

## STRATEGY

Without Queens, the game is slower and more positional. Bishops are limited to one colour each, making the pair complementary — losing one cripples your coverage of half the squares. Rooks need open files, which are created slowly with only single-step pawns. The King is relatively safer but the small board means it's never far from danger.

## ATTRIBUTION

Traditional variant, 19th century. Public domain.